[METRIC]

A-A-3020
October 29, 1991
SUPERSEDING
A-A-302C
April 15, 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BAG, PAPER (SHOPPING)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification UU-B-40 which is canceled.

This description covers paper shopping bags with loop handles.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A) Construction. Bags furnished under this description shall be made from paper which contains not less than 20 percent post consumer recovered material, as defined by 40 CFR Part 250. The paper used to make the bags shall have a Bursting Strength of not less than 248 kilopascals when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 403 and an average Internal Tearing Resistance in the machine direction of not less than 1079 millinewtons when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 414. Bags shall be self opening style with handles firmly attached at the top of the front face and at the top of the rear face of the bag, centered to within 13 millimeters. The handles shall be in the shape of a loop to provide a comfortable handgrip and shall extend not less than 89 millimeters beyond the top of the bag. Bags shall pass the load capacity test specified below.

B) Dimensions and capacity. The nominal dimensions of the bags, excluding the handles, shall be 430 millimeters by 330 millimeters by 180 millimeters, expressed as overall height x face width x bottom width. Bags shall have a cubic capacity of not less than 23 liters. Capacity shall be determined by multiplying overall height x face width x bottom width.

C) Workmanship. Bags shall be uniformly constructed, free from holes, tears, cuts, splits or any other defect that might impair their usefulness or affect their appearance. All seams shall adhere firmly throughout their area.

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2. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

A) Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B) Sampling. Bags and shipping containers shall be sampled in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

C) Examination of Bags for Construction, Capacity, and Workmanship. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The sample unit shall be 1 bag. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

D) Testing of the bags for Load Capacity. The lot size shall be expressed in units of bags. The Inspection Level shall be S-1, the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. The temperature shall be 17 - 32° C and the relative humidity shall be 15 - 85% in the area where the bags are tested while the tests are being performed.

1. Load the bag by gently placing 14 ± 0.5 kilograms of paper products such as paperbacked books inside the bag. By means of a clamp attached to the handles, suspend the loaded bag so that the bottom is not less than 6 inches above a horizontal surface. After not less than 60 minutes, take the bag down, unload it and examine it carefully. Any tear or break in the handle or in the area where the handle is attached to the bag constitutes failure of this test. Any tear or break in other parts of the bag exceeding 1 inch in length constitutes failure of this test. Any seam separation exceeding 1 inch in length constitutes failure of this test.

E) Examination of Packaging, Packing, Marking, and Palletization. The lot size shall be expressed in units of issue of bags. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container for Packaging, Packing, and Marking, and one fully prepared pallet for Palletization. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

3. PACKAGING, PACKING, MARKING, AND PALLETIZATION:

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Packaging, packing, marking, and palletization shall be as specified in the contract or order.

4. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS:

The issues of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

A) Industry Standards

TAPPI T 403 - Bursting strength of paper

TAPPI T 414 - Internal tearing resistance of paper (Elmendorf-type method)

These documents are available from TAPPI, 15 Technology Parkway South, P. O. Box 105113, Norcross, GA 30092.

B) Code of Federal Regulations

40 CFR Part 250

The Code of Federal Regulations is available from the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402

C) Military Standard

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

This document is available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

5. NOTES:

Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, marking, and palletization required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

No official DOD interest in this Commercial Item Description has been registered.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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